

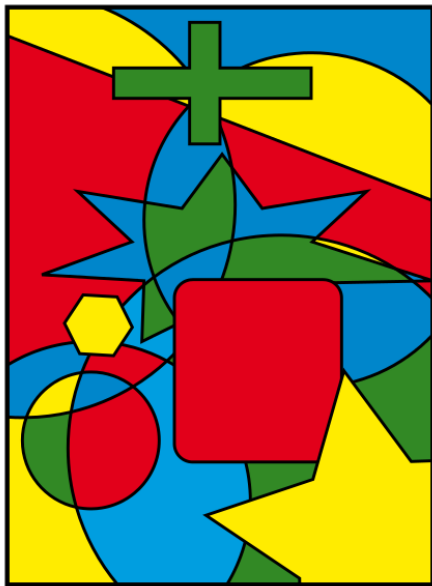
10-planarity-coloring: 平面图与图着色 (Planarity and Coloring)

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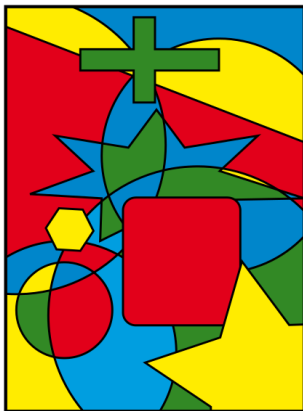
2026 年 05 月 18 日

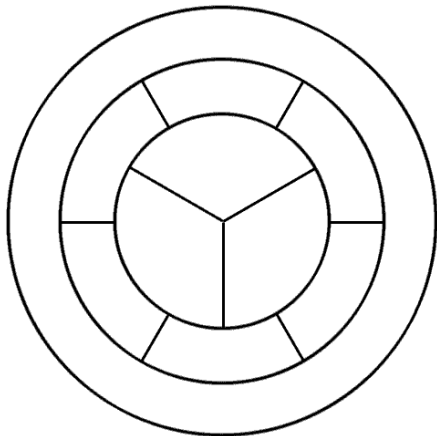


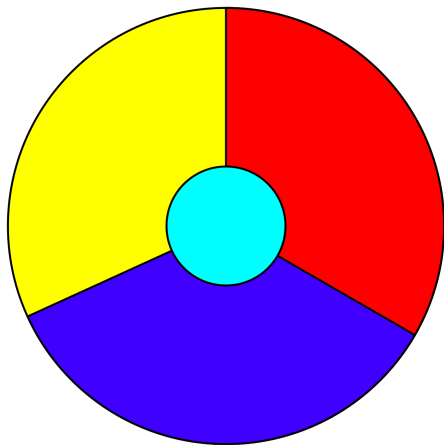


Theorem (Four Color (Map) Theorem (informal))

*Every **map** can be colored with only **four** colors such that no two **adjacent regions** share the same color.*







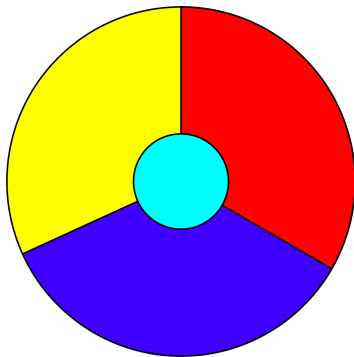
Every region is adjacent to the other 3 regions.

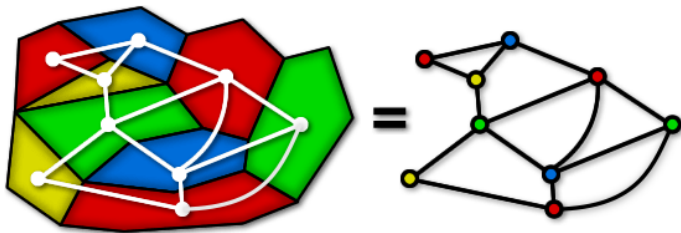
What if we have a map which contains 5 regions so that every region is adjacent to the other 4 regions?



IMPOSSIBLE™

What does Four Color Theorem to do with Graph Theory?

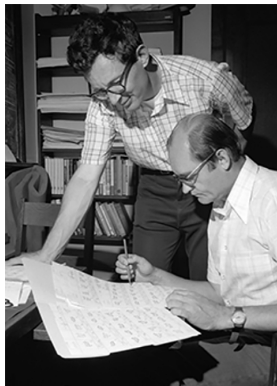




Every map produces a **planar** graph.

Theorem (Four Color Theorem (Kenneth Appel, Wolfgang Haken; 1976))

Every *simple planar* graph is *4-colorable*.



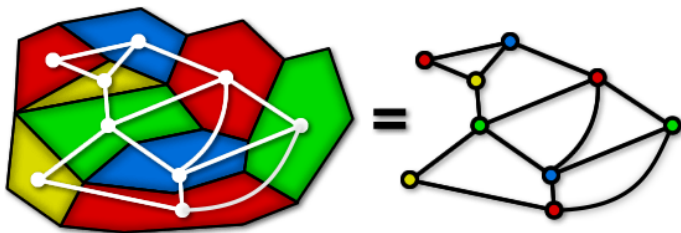
I will *not* show its proof (which I don't understand either)!

Theorem

Every simple planar graph is 6-colorable.

Theorem (Percy John Heawood (1890))

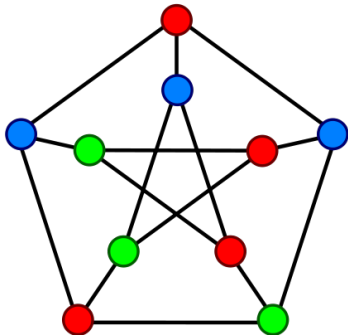
Every simple planar graph is 5-colorable.



Graph Coloring Problem

Definition (k -Colorable (k -可着色的))

If G is a connected undirected graph without loops, then G is k -colorable if its vertices can be colored in k colors so that adjacent vertices have different colors.

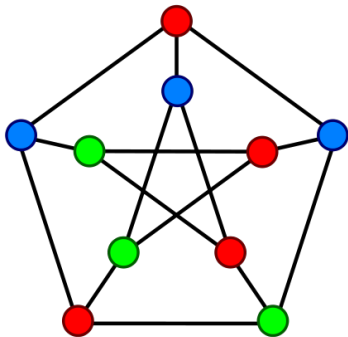


The Petersen graph is ≥ 3 -colorable.

Definition (k -Chromatic (k -色数的))

If G is k -colorable, but is not $(k - 1)$ -colorable, then G is k -chromatic.

$$\chi(G) = k$$



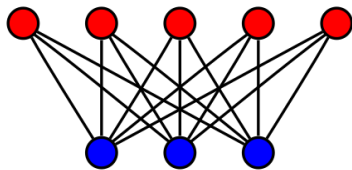
The Petersen graph is **3**-chromatic.
(It contains an **odd** cycle.)

Lemma

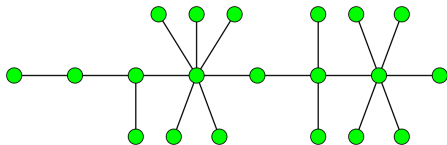
A graph is 1-colorable iff it is the empty graph with 1 vertex.

Theorem

A graph is 2-colorable iff it is *bipartite*.



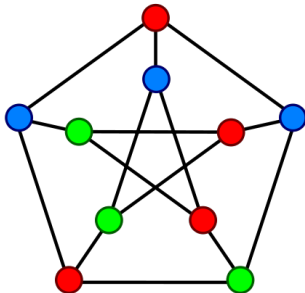
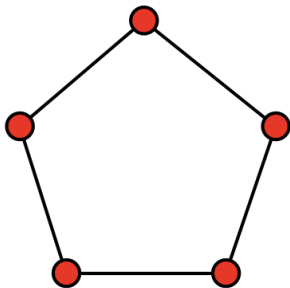
$K_{5,3}$



Trees are bipartite.

Theorem

The 3-coloring problem (i.e., testing whether a graph is 3-colorable or not) is NP-complete (HARD!).



Theorem

The 4-coloring problem is NP-complete (HARD!).

Theorem (Four Color Theorem (Kenneth Appel, Wolfgang Haken; 1976))

Every simple planar graph is 4-colorable.

Theorem

Let G be a simple connected graph. Then,

$$\chi(G) \leq \Delta(G) + 1.$$

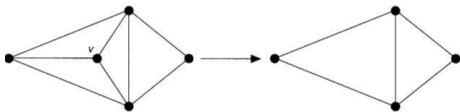
By induction on the number of vertices of G .

Basis Step: $n = 1$. $\chi(G) = 1$ and $\Delta(G) = 0$.

Induction Hypothesis: Suppose that for any simple connected graph G with n vertices,

$$\chi(G) \leq \Delta(G) + 1.$$

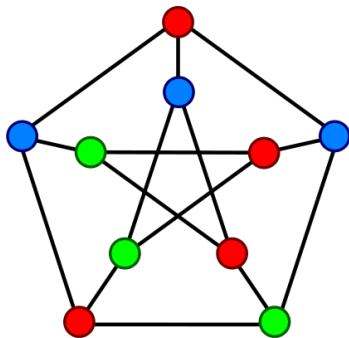
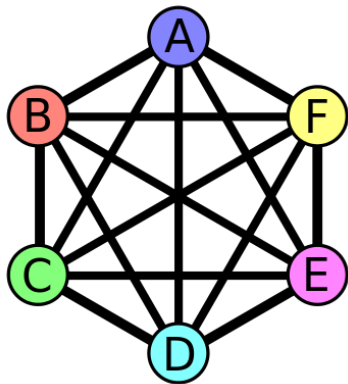
Induction Step: Consider a simple connected graph G with $n + 1$ vertices. $\deg(v) \leq \Delta(G)$



Theorem (Brooks's Theorem (R. Leonard Brooks; 1941))

Let G be a *simple* connected graph other than a *complete graph* or an *odd cycle*. Then

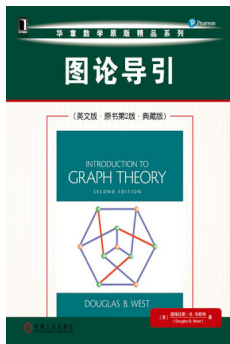
$$\chi(G) \leq \Delta(G).$$



Theorem (Brooks's Theorem (R. Leonard Brooks; 1941))

Let G be a *simple* connected graph other than a *complete graph* or an *odd cycle*. Then

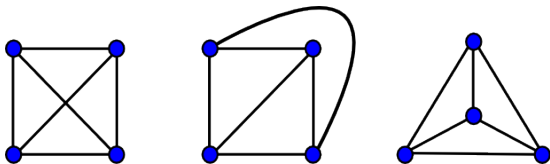
$$\chi(G) \leq \Delta(G).$$



Theorem 5.1.22

Definition (Planar Graph (平面图))

A **planar graph** is a graph that **can** be drawn in the plane without **edge crossings**.

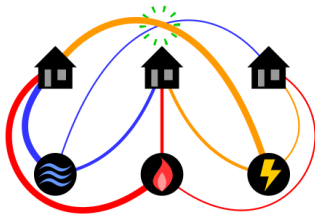
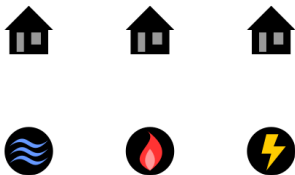
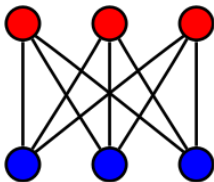


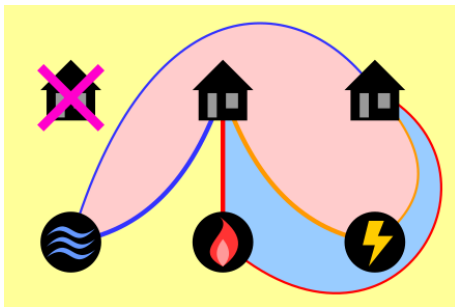
Theorem (K. Wagner (1936); I. Fáry (1948))

*Every simple planar graph can be drawn with **straight lines**.*

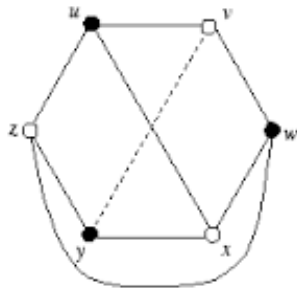
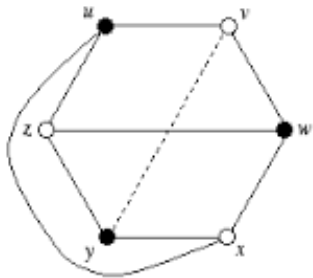
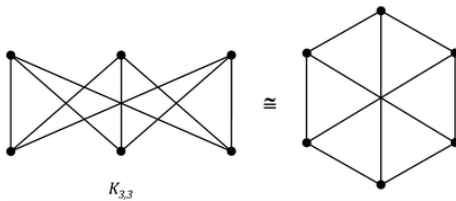
Theorem (Kazimierz Kuratowski, 1930)

The *utility graph* $K_{3,3}$ is non-planar.





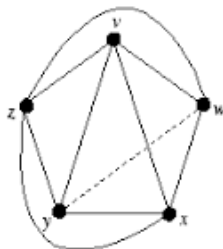
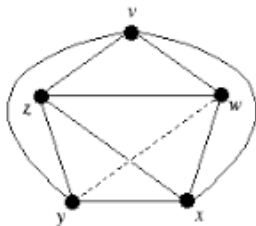
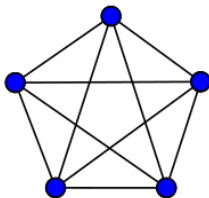
Proof without Words



$$\text{cr}(K_{3,3}) = 1 \quad (\text{crossing number})$$

Theorem

K_5 is non-planar.



$$\text{cr}(K_5) = 1$$

Theorem (Kazimierz Kuratowski, 1930)

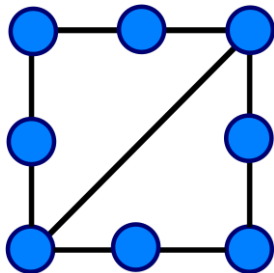
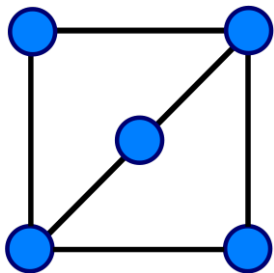
A graph is planar iff it contains no *subgraph homeomorphic to K_5 or $K_{3,3}$* .



*“The K in K_5 stands for Kazimierz,
and the K in $K_{3,3}$ stands for Kuratowski.”*

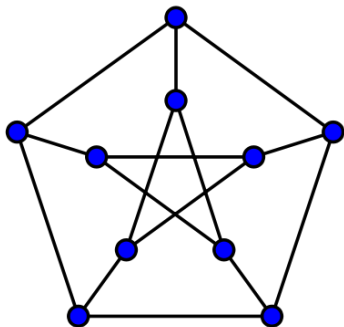
Definition (Homeomorphic)

Two graphs are **homeomorphic** if one can be obtained from another by **inserting or contracting** vertices of **degree 2**.

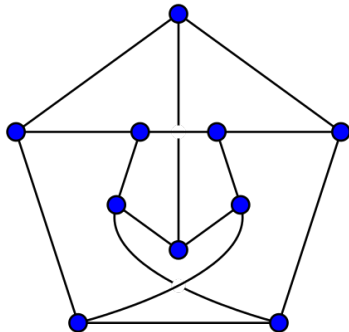
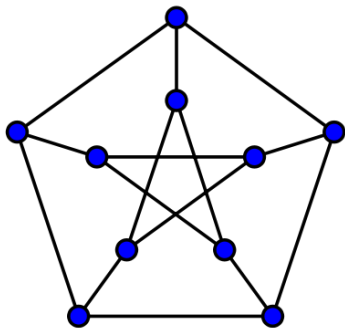


Theorem

The Petersen graph is non-planar.



[https://github.com/courses-at-nju-by-hfwei/
discrete-math-lectures/blob/main/11-planarity-coloring/
figs/Kuratowski-Petersen.gif](https://github.com/courses-at-nju-by-hfwei/discrete-math-lectures/blob/main/11-planarity-coloring/figs/Kuratowski-Petersen.gif)



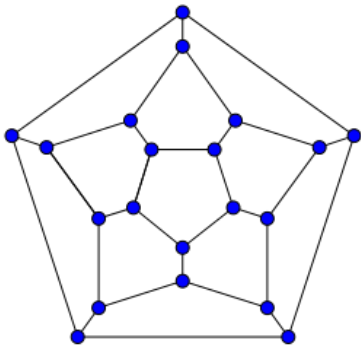
$$\text{cr}(\text{Petersen Graph}) = 2$$

A planar graph should not has too many edges.

Theorem (Euler's Formula, 1750)

Let G be a *plane drawing* of a *connected* planar graph, and let n , m , and f denote respectively the number of vertices, edges, and *faces* of G .

$$n - m + f = 2$$

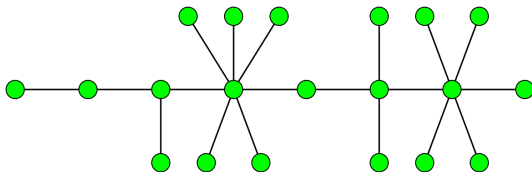


$$n - m + f = 20 - 30 + 12 = 2$$

Theorem (Euler's Formula, 1750)

Let G be a *plane drawing* of a *connected* planar graph, and let n , m , and f denote respectively the number of vertices, edges, and *faces* of G .

$$n - m + f = 2$$



$$n - m + f = n - (n - 1) + 1 = 2$$

By induction on the number of edges of G .

Basis Step: $m = 0$. We have $n = 1$ and $f = 1$.

Induction Hypothesis: It holds for plane graphs with m edges.

Induction Step: Consider a plane graph G with $m + 1$ edges.

If G is a tree, we are done.

Otherwise, G contains a cycle.

Let e be an edge in some cycle of G .

Consider $G' = G - e$.

$$n - (m - 1) + (f - 1) = 2$$

Therefore,

$$n - m + f = 2$$

Theorem

Let G be a simple connected planar graph with $n \geq 3$ vertices and m edges. Then

$$m \leq 3n - 6.$$

$$n - m + f = 2$$

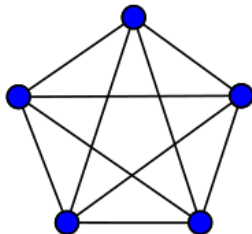
$$3f \leq 2m$$

Double Counting:

each face is bounded by ≥ 3 edges;
each edge bounds 2 faces

Theorem

K_5 is non-planar.

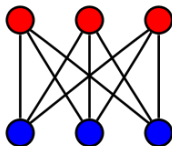


$$m \leq 3n - 6$$

$$10 \leq 3 \times 5 - 6$$

Theorem

$K_{3,3}$ is non-planar.



$$m \leq 3n - 6$$

$$9 \leq 3 \times 6 - 6$$

FAILED

Theorem

Let G be a simple connected planar graph with $n \geq 3$ vertices and m edges. *If G has no triangles, then*

$$m \leq 2n - 4.$$

$$n - m + f = 2$$

$$4f \leq 2m$$

Theorem

$K_{3,3}$ is non-planar.

$$m \leq 2n - 4$$

$$9 \leq 2 \times 6 - 4$$

Theorem

Every simple planar graph contains a vertex of degree ≤ 5 .

$$m \leq 3n - 6$$

Suppose that, **by contradiction**, $\delta(G) \geq 6$.

$$6n \leq 2m$$

$$3n \leq m \leq 3n - 6$$

Theorem

Every *simple planar* graph is *6-colorable*.

By induction on the number of vertices.

Basis Step: $n = 1$. Trivial.

Induction Hypothesis: Suppose that it holds for simple planar graphs with $n \geq 1$ vertices.

Induction Step: Consider a simple planar graph G with $n + 1$ vertices.

G contains a vertex v of degree ≤ 5 .

$G' = G - v$ is 6-colorable.

Thus, G is 6-colorable. ($\deg(v) \leq 5$)

Theorem (Percy John Heawood (1890))

Every *simple planar* graph is *5-colorable*.

By induction on the number of vertices.

Basis Step: $n = 1$. Trivial.

Induction Hypothesis: Suppose that it holds for simple planar graphs with $n \geq 1$ vertices.

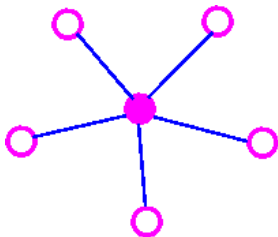
Induction Step: Consider a simple planar graph G with $n + 1$ vertices.

G contains a vertex v of degree ≤ 5 .

$G' = G - v$ is *5-colorable*.

If $\deg(v) < 5$, G is 5-colorable.

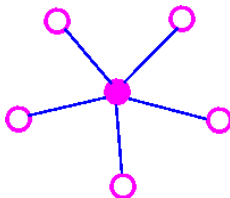
Now assume that $\deg(v) = 5$.



$$\{v, v_1\}, \{v, v_2\}, \{v, v_3\}, \{v, v_4\}, \{v, v_5\}$$

If v_1, v_2, v_3, v_4 , and v_5 uses < 5 colors, we are done.

Now assume that v_1, v_2, v_3, v_4 , and v_5 uses 5 colors.



Suppose that there is *no* $v_1 \sim v_3$ path in $G' = G - v$,
all of whose vertices are colored **red** or **blue**.

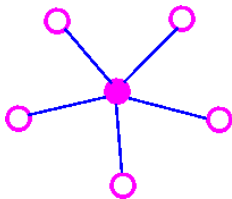
Let S be the set of all **red** or **blue** vertices of $G - v$
connected to v_1 by a red-blue path.

$$v_1 \in S, \quad v_3 \notin S$$

Interchange the colors of the vertices in S

Coloring v **red** produces a 5-coloring of G .

Now assume that there *is* a $v_1 \sim v_3$ path in $G' = G - v$,
all of whose vertices are colored red or blue.

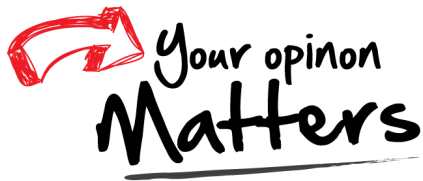


There cannot be $v_2 \sim v_4$ path in $G' = G - v$,
all of whose vertices are colored green or purple.

(Otherwise, G' and thus G is non-planar.)

By similar argument, G is 5-colorable.

Thank
You!



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